

daily eater -1

How many mornings a week do you eat breakfast at the mess, and how many do you skip?

I don't skip breakfast generally. Mostly, I skip on Sundays. Some days I have breakfast from outside. Other than that, I have breakfast almost every day, except for maybe one or two days.

On a morning you skip, what's the usual reason?

Maybe if I've stayed up late because of assignments or classes, or if I sleep around 3:00 or 4:00 a.m. or later, I don't tend to wake up. I prefer sleep over breakfast. Other than that, in all cases I generally have breakfast.

On a morning you go, what makes you decide to go right then?

There's no other reason. I generally prefer to have my breakfast to start my day.

Do you check the app before deciding to go or skip?

I didn't specifically mention checking the app before deciding whether to go or skip. There is an option in the app to check the mess crowd, but I rarely check it.

Does anyone else, like a roommate or friend, factor into whether you go?

No. I generally go alone for breakfast, so it doesn't matter.

If that person was away for a week, do you think your attendance would change?

No, it wouldn't really matter.

What's the queue/counter usually like when you get there?

If I have an 8:30 class, I usually go around 7:30 or 8:00. The counter is very peaceful then, and I can get whatever I want. But most days I go around 9:00 to 9:30, and it is usually very crowded. Especially after 9:15, it's very crowded, and it's not guaranteed that I'll get all the things I want.

Has an item ever run out by the time you got there — which one, roughly when?

Yes. Most of the time when I'm at Kadamba around 9:20, the main items are already finished. Things like idli, puri, and bhatura often run out. The fruits also get taken away, and they don't always provide new fruits. Many times, items have run out, and the staff has promised to bring them back before the mess closes at 9:30, but they don't tend to return the items that have run out.

Do you register day-by-day or all at once for the week?

I register for a month, not day by day. I usually register for Kadamba or Bugul for the whole month.

Have you ever cancelled a registration?

Yes, I cancel registrations, probably around five times.

Have you used "Skip Meal"? What do you think it actually does?

I never use Skip Meal because it doesn't return the money. It just lets them know that the meal

can be skipped, whereas they are already preparing food for only some percentage of the registered students.

Have you ever bought or sold a registration on Mess Cell WhatsApp?

Yes, I have both bought and sold registrations.

Have you ever eaten as a walk-in without being registered?

Yes, I've walked in and eaten without being registered for snacks, but not for breakfast.

Do you ever register somewhere just in case, planning to resell it if you don't go?

No, I don't generally do that. I register for a month, and if I don't feel like eating, I may sell the registration. Sometimes I don't sell it either.

Has how often you eat breakfast changed this semester — since when?

Yes. This semester I've been more regular with eating breakfast.

Do you have a sense of when the mess is busiest?

Yes. There is an option in the app to check the mess crowd, but I rarely check it. I don't really care if the mess is busy.

Do you usually eat with others — does that decide whether you go?

No. I prefer eating alone. If somebody is there, I'll eat with them, but that doesn't decide whether I go or not.

Have you or anyone you know tried to get a mess rule/timing changed? What happened?

No. Sometimes when food runs out or some technical errors happen, the mess makes changes, but those are usually just immediate changes related to those particular issues.

Do you think students have real input in mess decisions?

Maybe students have some input in things like menu-making, but other than that, for institutional or organizational-level changes, I don't think students really have much input.

Would breakfast starting an hour later change anything for you?

Not starting an hour later, but ending an hour later would help me.

How much do you think you've spent this semester on breakfasts you didn't eat?

Not much, especially this semester. It might be less than ₹500 because I'm a regular breakfast eater.

Anything else about breakfast/mess worth mentioning?

They should prepare food for more people, and they should increase the breakfast timing. It's an absolute waste of money for almost everyone because most people don't actually eat breakfast, and the current system doesn't seem to account properly for the people who do come.

daily eater - 2

daily eater - 3

How many mornings a week do you eat breakfast at the mess, and how many do you skip?

I eat breakfast at the mess on most days. I do sometimes miss breakfast, especially when I have an early 8:30 class or when I've stayed up very late because of assignments, deadlines, or other commitments. If I can't wake up by around 9:00, I might end up skipping it.

On a morning you skip, what's the usual reason?

Usually, it's because I've slept very late, sometimes around 3:00 or 4:00 a.m., and then I'm not able to wake up in time. If I have an 8:30 class and I wake up around 8:00 or 8:30, I prioritize going to class because of the attendance policy rather than going for breakfast and coming back.

On a morning you go, what makes you decide to go right then?

I usually decide to go once I'm properly awake and alert, around 8:30 or so. Sometimes I spend 10–30 minutes scrolling through my phone, reading messages, or looking at the news. Then I brush my teeth and plan to leave the hostel by around 9:00 so that I can reach Kadamba within 5–10 minutes. I generally make sure I get my breakfast before moving on to my other commitments.

Do you check the app before deciding to go or skip?

I'm registered for breakfast, but I didn't specifically mention checking the app before deciding whether to go. My decision is mostly based on my schedule and whether I'm able to wake up in time.

Does anyone else, like a roommate or friend, factor into whether you go?

Sometimes. I try to wake up my friends and encourage them to come with me. But if they don't wake up, I prioritize my own breakfast and leave. I'll tell them to get ready and catch up later.

If that person was away for a week, do you think your attendance would change?

Probably not. I might prefer eating with my friends, but even if they don't come, I'll still prioritize having my breakfast.

What's the queue/counter usually like when you get there?

I usually plan to reach Kadamba around 9:00 to 9:30. During that time, there can be a lot of crowding. The demand is high and many people start queuing around the same time, so the queue can become quite long.

Has an item ever run out by the time you got there — which one, roughly when?

Yes, I've experienced situations where the food supply becomes very low around 9:00 to 9:30. Since there are many people queuing and the demand is high, the available food can become insufficient. Sometimes the mess may not be able to arrange more food quickly enough, which creates a bad experience.

Do you register day-by-day or all at once for the week?

I'm generally registered for breakfast. The interview doesn't specify whether I register day-by-day or all at once.

Have you ever cancelled a registration?

I haven't specifically mentioned cancelling registrations. Sometimes I unintentionally miss breakfast because I'm unable to wake up on time, rather than deliberately planning to skip it.

Have you used "Skip Meal"? What do you think it actually does?

I haven't specifically mentioned using Skip Meal.

Have you ever bought or sold a registration on Mess Cell WhatsApp?

I haven't mentioned buying or selling registrations on WhatsApp.

Have you ever eaten as a walk-in without being registered?

I haven't mentioned eating as a walk-in.

Do you ever register somewhere just in case, planning to resell it if you don't go?

I haven't mentioned doing this.

Has how often you eat breakfast changed this semester — since when?

I generally eat breakfast on most days, although I occasionally miss it because of late nights, assignments, deadlines, or early classes.

Do you have a sense of when the mess is busiest?

Yes. Around 9:00 to 9:30, there seems to be a lot of crowding because many people start queuing around the same time. The demand is high during this period.

Do you usually eat with others — does that decide whether you go?

I try to eat with my friends and usually try to wake them up so they can come with me. But it doesn't determine whether I go. If they don't wake up, I'll still go and have breakfast by myself.

Have you or anyone you know tried to get a mess rule/timing changed? What happened?

I haven't personally mentioned trying to change the mess rules or timings. However, I think there should be some organizational-level changes to address the breakfast supply problem. If the statistics show that only around 30% of registered students actually come for breakfast, but the mess still isn't able to arrange enough food for those who do come, management should look into it.

Do you think students have real input in mess decisions?

I haven't directly mentioned whether students have real input, but I feel that management needs to be more involved in addressing the issues students experience, especially with food availability and organization.

Would breakfast starting an hour later change anything for you?

I haven't specifically said that starting breakfast an hour later would change my attendance. My

main issue is being able to fit breakfast around early classes and my morning schedule. Better timing or a more flexible breakfast window could potentially help on mornings when I wake up late.

How much do you think you've spent this semester on breakfasts you didn't eat?

I haven't mentioned a specific amount.

Anything else about breakfast/mess worth mentioning?

The quality of the breakfast at the mess is generally decent, and that's one reason I continue to prefer eating at Kadamba. However, the biggest issue is the mismatch between demand and food availability around 9:00 to 9:30. There can be a large crowd, while the food supply is already running low. Even though only around 30% of registered students may actually show up, the mess sometimes still struggles to arrange enough food for the students who do come. I think this needs to be addressed at an organizational or management level so that the food supply better matches actual demand and students don't have a bad experience after making the effort to come for breakfast.

skip - 1

How many mornings a week do you eat breakfast at the mess, and how many do you skip?

I have breakfast at the mess maybe once a week. Other than that, I usually don't have breakfast, maybe just some biscuits.

On a morning you skip, what's the usual reason?

Usually, I'm not hungry. If I'm not hungry, I'll skip breakfast.

On a morning you go, what makes you decide to go right then?

If there is something good being served, mostly. And if I'm hungry, that's usually what makes me decide to go.

Do you check the app before deciding to go or skip?

Yes, I check the app before deciding. If I'm not hungry, I'll skip. If I'm hungry, I'll check what's being served and then decide.

Does anyone else, like a roommate or friend, factor into whether you go?

Not particularly.

If that person was away for a week, do you think your attendance would change?

No, not particularly.

What's the queue/counter usually like when you get there?

It's usually manageable, and there's not much of a queue.

Has an item ever run out by the time you got there? Which one, roughly when?

Yes, some items have run out by the time I got there, sometimes around two o'clock.

Do you register day-by-day or all at once for the week?

I usually register beforehand, and sometimes I register all at once.

Have you ever cancelled a registration?

Yes, I have cancelled a registration before.

Have you used "Skip Meal"? What do you think it actually does?

I have not used Skip Meal. As per my understanding, it basically lets them know that this person is not going to come for the meal, so they can account for the food accordingly.

Have you ever bought or sold a registration on Mess Cell WhatsApp?

I have seen it a few times.

Have you ever eaten as a walk-in without being registered?

Yes, I have.

Do you ever register somewhere just in case, planning to resell it if you don't go?

No.

Has how often you eat breakfast changed this semester — since when?

Yes, it has changed this semester, mainly since just before the classes started.

Do you have a sense of when the mess is busiest?

Around the beginning and the end of the class timings.

Do you usually eat with others — does that decide whether you go?

Sometimes, but not particularly. It doesn't really decide whether I go.

Have you or anyone you know tried to get a mess rule/timing changed? What happened?

No. But I would prefer if the timings were a bit more lenient. For example, breakfast should also be available after the first class, maybe until around 10:15, so that people who miss breakfast in the morning can still have it afterwards.

Do you think students have real input in mess decisions?

I don't think so.

Would breakfast starting an hour later change anything for you?

If breakfast started or ended an hour later, maybe I would change how often I have breakfast at the mess.

How much do you think you've spent this semester on breakfasts you didn't eat?

A lot, almost all of it.

Anything else about breakfast/mess worth mentioning?

I think the breakfast timing should definitely be increased or extended. It would be more convenient if breakfast was available for a longer period, especially until around 10:15, so students who have an early class or miss breakfast in the morning still have the option to eat.

skip - 2

How many mornings a week do you eat breakfast at the mess, and how many do you skip?

I don't go to the mess for breakfast. Anyway, I haven't been to the mess for a whole semester.

On a morning you skip, what's the usual reason?

I might be sleeping, or I don't feel hungry that early in the morning. I might eat something after 10 or 10:30, but not before that.

On a morning you go, what makes you decide to go right then?

I don't go to eat breakfast ever, so there is nothing to decide.

Do you check the app before deciding to go or skip?

I don't check the app. It's not a deciding factor for me.

Does anyone else, like a roommate or friend, factor into whether you go?

No, my roommate or friends are not a deciding factor either.

If that person was away for a week, do you think your attendance would change?

No, my attendance wouldn't change. That doesn't matter to me.

What's the queue/counter usually like when you get there?

The queue and counter aren't really a factor for me. That's not the reason I don't attend breakfast.

Has an item ever run out by the time you got there — which one, roughly when?

Whenever I went for breakfast, usually after 8:30 or 9:00, most of the things would run out of stock.

Do you register day-by-day or all at once for the week?

I don't register day by day. It's just random allocation. I don't register for the mess.

Have you ever cancelled a registration?

I don't even cancel the registration because I forget.

Have you used "Skip Meal"? What do you think it actually does?

I haven't ever used Skip Meal. I think it just shows them that we're skipping the meal, but I don't think I've ever used that feature.

Have you ever bought or sold a registration on Mess Cell WhatsApp?

Yes, I have bought and sold my breakfast registration in the Mess WhatsApp group, but mostly I've bought registrations for lunch and dinner, and never for breakfast.

Have you ever eaten as a walk-in without being registered?

I've never walked in for breakfast without a registration.

Do you ever register somewhere just in case, planning to resell it if you don't go?

No, I don't ever register somewhere just to plan to resell it. I haven't done much reselling. It's just that whenever I remember, I do it. Otherwise, most of the time, it just goes to waste.

Has how often you eat breakfast changed this semester — since when?

I haven't eaten breakfast at the mess this semester.

Do you have a sense of when the mess is busiest?

I don't know when the mess is busiest because I've never really checked it.

Do you usually eat with others — does that decide whether you go?

I usually go with others, but that doesn't decide whether I want to go or not.

Have you or anyone you know tried to get a mess rule/timing changed? What happened?

I don't know if anyone I know has ever tried to do that, so I can't really say anything about it.

Do you think students have real input in mess decisions?

I don't think students have real input in mess decisions because we have so many issues, and they have never really been addressed.

Would breakfast starting an hour later change anything for you?

Yes. If the timing is better, definitely. I might start going for breakfast.

How much do you think you've spent this semester on breakfasts you didn't eat?

I think around ₹1,500 goes to waste on my breakfast.

Anything else about breakfast/mess worth mentioning?

If we could extend the breakfast timing a little later, and also have the option to cancel our breakfast when we're not going to use it, that would be a good system. It would help reduce the amount of food and money that goes to waste.

skip - 3

How many mornings a week do you eat breakfast at the mess, and how many do you skip?

I haven't been having breakfast regularly for maybe the last six to three weeks. I rarely eat breakfast.

On a morning you skip, what's the usual reason?

The usual reason is that I sleep very late, sometimes until around 3 or 4 in the morning, and then I'm not feeling hungry in the morning. That's the main reason I skip breakfast.

On a morning you go, what makes you decide to go right then?

If I'm feeling hungry, that's the main reason. Or if I have a very busy schedule ahead, I feel like I'm lacking something to start the day, so I'll go have breakfast.

Do you check the app before deciding to go or skip?

I don't really check the app for that.

Does anyone else, like a roommate or friend, factor into whether you go?

Yes. If my friends are going, then I'll go. I get the motivation to go, basically just to hang out with them.

If that person was away for a week, do you think your attendance would change?

Not really. My friends are a positive factor in deciding to go, but if I have to go, I'll go.

What's the queue/counter usually like when you get there?

Whenever I'm eating breakfast, I try to go early, so it's usually empty. I don't really want to end up in queues. I think the peak hours are around 8:00 to 8:30 or 8:00 to 9:00.

Has an item ever run out by the time you got there — which one, roughly when?

I don't really go around during the peak hours, so I haven't noticed anything specific running out.

Do you register day-by-day or all at once for the week?

I try to catch the registrations. I register for breakfast for the whole month because Kadamba is hard to get and it gets full.

Have you ever cancelled a registration?

Yes, but not daily for breakfast. I rarely cancel breakfast registrations.

Have you used "Skip Meal"? What do you think it actually does?

No, I've never used Skip Meal.

Have you ever bought or sold a registration on Mess Cell WhatsApp?

Yes, but rarely.

Have you ever eaten as a walk-in without being registered?

I have never eaten as a walk-in. I don't remember a time when I've eaten breakfast as a walk-in.

Do you ever register somewhere just in case, planning to resell it if you don't go?

Yes. I do register for breakfast for the whole month because Kadamba is hard to get and it gets full. But I resell breakfast very rarely, because breakfast registrations can sometimes be available at a nice price.

Has how often you eat breakfast changed this semester — since when?

Yes, I haven't been eating breakfast regularly for the last several weeks.

Do you have a sense of when the mess is busiest?

I think the peak hours are around 8:00 to 8:30 or 8:00 to 9:00.

Do you usually eat with others — does that decide whether you go?

Yes, if my friends are going, I'll usually go. It's a positive motivation for me because I get to hang out with them.

Have you or anyone you know tried to get a mess rule/timing changed? What happened?

I don't think so. Some things are very concrete, like the timings, and there are different constraints involved, so I don't think these things can easily change. But of course, the spending and utilization for the day has to make sense.

Do you think students have real input in mess decisions?

I don't think so.

Would breakfast starting an hour later change anything for you?

Increasing the breakfast time period would definitely help, I think. If the breakfast timing were extended, I would be more likely to use it.

How much do you think you've spent this semester on breakfasts you didn't eat?

I'm not exactly sure. Since I rarely eat breakfast, I think it would probably be somewhere around ₹500 to ₹1,000.

Anything else about breakfast/mess worth mentioning?

I think there should be a canteen-style option where you can just go and buy things for breakfast. Maybe it could be done through a QR-based system where money can be added as needed, rather than having a fixed amount of money. Otherwise, you pay for breakfast but don't necessarily utilize the money, especially when you skip breakfast. Extending the breakfast timing would also help.